

A photograph of three students sitting outdoors, smiling and looking towards the right. The student on the left is a woman with long brown hair wearing a black t-shirt with a blue and red graphic. The student in the middle is a man with dark curly hair wearing a red Nike t-shirt with a blue and white logo. The student on the right is a woman with dark hair wearing a white t-shirt with blue and red text that says "CKC BLUE DEVILS FOOTBALL". They are all holding books or papers.

Kansas City Kansas
Community College™

STRATEGIC ENROLLMENT MANAGEMENT PLAN

2023-2028

KCKCC 2023-2028 STRATEGIC ENROLLMENT MANAGEMENT PLAN

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MESSAGE FROM PRESIDENT GREG MOSIER

I'm pleased to share with you Kansas City Kansas Community College's Strategic Enrollment Management (SEM) plan, the culmination of a 15-month, College-wide planning process designed to increase student success and completion. The plan is aligned with the College's strategic plan and priorities, and reflects the need to operate with clarity and urgency as we advance our recruitment and enrollment efforts to meet students where, they are, address their unique interests and needs, and ensure their success.

KCKCC's SEM plan recognizes the need to create new and engaging opportunities to attract more students to Kansas City Kansas Community College and addresses equity gaps in student retention, persistence, and completion. As a living document, the plan will be continually informed, adjusted, and implemented by the SEM Council and the wider College community.

KCKCC plays a unifying role in Wyandotte County and the greater Kansas City metropolitan region, offering hope and pathways to opportunity and upward socioeconomic mobility to individuals across our community. This plan and our corresponding work expands access to affordable, high-quality education and workforce training that prepares students to transfer to our university partners and to enter the workforce.

Thank you for your continued dedication to our students and our College. Your contributions are greatly appreciated.

*Sincerely,
Dr. Greg Mosier
President*

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

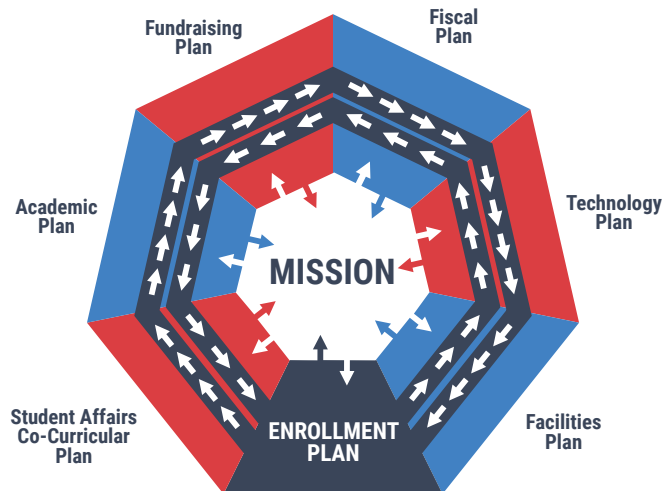
Kansas City Kansas Community College's competitive position in the greater Kansas City metropolitan area has never been stronger. To that point, the Strategic Enrollment Management (SEM) Council has outlined a plan to achieve a **full-time student equivalent of 3,530 (FTE)** by the Fall 2028 semester matching the Fall 2019 enrollment.

The SEM plan is designed to adopt an inclusive framework to galvanize the rallying cry that **enrollment management and student success is everyone's responsibility at KCKCC**. Everyone at KCKCC can make a difference towards creating a premiere postsecondary educational experience in Wyandotte and Leavenworth Counties.

SEM Calls to Action

- Obtaining **better information about our new and prospective students and emerging markets**. By forecasting and collecting more information about a student's educational goals, KCKCC will be better positioned to plan and be ready for dynamic and evolving changes in the higher education market.
- Creating **better and more frequent communication across the College** to support student success.
- Increasing **retention and completion rates**. With increasing competition, timely degree completion is imperative. All aspects of the student journey through KCKCC must be optimized to reduce barriers and bottlenecks that could prevent students from achieving their goals.
- Adopting more holistic **inclusion and equity practices** into our work to further reduce equity gaps in student achievement to fulfill the promise of upward mobility that education provides.
- **Modernizing operations, structures, processes and systems** are key to our work. Chatbots, automation software, and increasing our capacity in leveraging data to inform decision-making will allow the College to better serve students in an omni-channel approach and position the College to fulfill the spirit of the mission to make a difference one student at a time.

The SEM plan is integrated with the College's strategic planning process. This integration aligns the SEM's plan data-driven outcomes and strategies to KCKCC's enrollment, equity, fiscal, and mission-driven priorities.



This plan includes measurable SEM Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) to assess the College's performance toward accomplishing its SEM goals.

To move towards a continuous planning and implementation SEM planning framework at KCKCC, the SEM plan also outlines the following themes and specific strategies starting featuring five goals.

- Enhance and Grow the Enrollment Funnel
- Improve Student Persistence and Completion
- Improve the Student Experience
- Leverage Financial Assistance to Improve Student Outcomes and Fiscal Health
- Develop and Enhance KCKCC SEM Processes and Policies

PLANNING ASSUMPTIONS

The College's SEM plan is based on the following assumptions:

- **Student success and engagement are paramount.** The SEM plan must align with KCKCC's purpose to fully enhance student intellectual and social development so that students develop the skills required for effective learning and citizenship in a multicultural democracy.
- **Equity is everyone's work.** Our students' well-being, sense of belonging, inclusion, and affinity to the College are critical to their academic and personal success. We must be committed to intentionally creating positive student experiences and safe learning environments for our students.
- **Enrollment management is part science and part art.** Although various data points can be analyzed in the development of the SEM plan, there is still an element of unpredictability as to whether the return on investment will be at the levels predicted. The College must recognize when strategies and programs must be given more time to develop or abandoned altogether.
- **Being strategic requires making tough decisions.** As the College looks to create improved systems responsive to the needs of our students and employers partners, continuous analysis and the willingness to make tough decisions are necessary for the institution's viability. Both quantitative and qualitative data should be used in the College's decision-making.
- **The SEM plan is never done.** Continuous improvement does not lend itself to a one-and-done mentality. Although a rendition of the SEM plan may be deemed complete, it must constantly be monitored and updated as institutional priorities shift.

KCKCC SEM SWOT ANALYSIS

To illustrate the call to advance a more strategic approach to enrollment management across KCKCC, a SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats) framework was used to highlight examples of internal and external factors impacting student enrollment at the College.

Strengths

Growth of High School Partnerships

Since 2012, dual and concurrent enrollment has grown 131% in student headcount and now accounts for 27% of the total student headcount.

Persistence of Students Enrolled in Blue 101

Students who enroll in Blue 101 for the first Fall semester at KCKCC are 12% more likely to enroll in the following spring semester.

Weaknesses

Underperforming Retention Rates

KCKCC's Fall-to-Fall retention rates based on U.S. Department of Education IPEDS definitions continue to drop while its IPEDS and regional peers rise or stabilize:

FULL-TIME STUDENTS		
	2020 Cohort	2021 Cohort
KCKCC	56.0%	51.0%
IPEDS Peers	59.7%	61.6%
Regional Peers	61.8%	61.3%

Dual and Concurrent Students Enrolling after High School Graduation

Of the 905 Spring 2022 high school graduates that enrolled in a KCKCC dual or concurrent course, only 27% of the students enrolled as KCKCC first-time, first-year students for the Fall 2022 semester.

Degree and Certificate Achievement Gaps

KCKCC African American earn 6% and females earn 4% fewer degrees and certificates than the overall KCKCC average.

KCKCC Students Transferring to Other Community Colleges

From 2018-2022, nearly 25% of the students that transferred to another institution without earning a degree or credential at KCKCC transferred to another community college.

Placement Testing Preparation

On average, students improve their placement test scores at least nine points by making a second test attempt even though only 7% of all students attempt placements tests more than once.

Opportunities

Growth of Micro-credentials

Micro-credentials can be seen as a transformation of the community college experience. In addition to further facilitating a guided pathways advising model, micro-credentials, or micro-pathways (stackable offerings), have also been found to better support the needs of online learners.ⁱ

Increasing Online and Hybrid Course Offerings

Almost 75% of all students are interested in online course offerings. For students who are seeking online course offerings, 55% of students preferred hybrid delivery compared to 45% that prefer completely online offerings.ⁱⁱ

Guided Pathways

Transitioning from the cafeteria-style advising model to a guided pathways approach is a promising strategy to reduce structural and motivational barriers.

One-Stop Shop for Students

A student's satisfaction with course registration and financial aid office interactions was generally higher if their college had an one stop-shop for student services.

Threats

Declining Number of High School Graduates in Wyandotte County

According to the Kansas Department of Education, the number of high school graduates in Wyandotte County dropped 3.8% from 2011 to 2022.

Historically Low Unemployment in Wyandotte County

According to the Department of Labor, the 2009-2021 Wyandotte County unemployment annual average rate was 7.0%. The 2022 annual average unemployment rate was 3.6%.

Changes to the Federal Financial Aid System

Delays to the implementation of the Federal Application for Student Financial Assistance (FAFSA) Simplification act has created uncertainty about how Pell Grant eligibility will be calculated.ⁱⁱⁱ



SEM PLAN GOALS AND KPIS

The overall SEM plan goal is to achieve a **3,530 FTE** by the **Fall 2028 semester**. KCKCC must add 663 FTE based or 133 FTE annually (3.8% annual growth rate) to achieve this goal.

The following KPIs are based on historical enrollment at KCKCC. Considering multiple external and internal factors ultimately drive enrollment, the KPIs illustrate the cumulative impacts of aligning enrollment outcomes with overall institutional plans and strategies.

KCKCC Strategic Plan Priority 1, Goal 1 (Student-Centered Processes)

Increase the Number of Fall Applications for Admission by 18%

KCKCC received 5,149 applications for the Fall 2022 semester. Based on the current enrollment to applicant yield rate of 33%, the College would generate an additional **219 FTE** annually.

Increase the Percentage of Admitted to Enrolled Fall Students by 2.5%

From 2015-22, KCKCC enrolled on average 35.8% of the students admitted for the fall semester. Increasing the yield by 0.5% every year would yield an additional **181 FTE** annually on top of the gains attributed by increasing the number of applications for admissions.

Increase the Number of Converted Dual and Concurrent Students into Full-Time Students by 15%

Assuming an unlikely scenario of no growth in the number of dual and concurrent high school students, annually converting 15% more dual and concurrent students into first-time, first-year students would yield an additional **135 FTE** annually.

KCKCC Strategic Plan Priority 1, Goal 2 (Retention and Persistence)

For the Fall 2021 cohort, the total new FTE was 1,130 and the fall-to-fall retention rate was at 51%. By achieving a fall-to-fall full-time retention rate of 58%, KCKCC would add an additional **80 FTE**.

Every KCKCC Degree- or Certificate-Seeking Student Has a Completion Plan by the End of their First Semester

Plans tailored to address the specific needs of students will help them navigate their educational journey with some certainty and ability to balance their educational and personal lives.

Improve the Student FTE to Headcount Ratio by 5%

The FTE to headcount ratio has remained stable at 60% since 2016. By improving the FTE to headcount ratio to 65%, KCKCC would add an **290 FTE** annually.

Improve the Student FTE to Headcount Ratio for Low-Income Students by 17% points

On average, for Pell eligible students, the FTE to headcount ratio is 70% compared to 53% for non-Pell eligible students. For the Fall 2022 semester, closing this gap would add an additional **313 FTE** annually.

Reduce the Percentage of Low-Income Students Taking Developmental Education Courses by 21% as Outlined in the College's Title III Grant

Since Fall 2018, 39% of Pell eligible students have taken developmental education courses compared to 21% of non-Pell eligible students.

Increase the Percentage of African American Completing a Non-Developmental Course after Passing Developmental Reading by 3%

Since Fall 2018, 59% of all students pass a non-developmental course after developmental reading compared to 56% of African American students.

KCKCC Strategic Plan Priority 1, Goal 3 (150% Completion Time)

Improve African American Degree and Certificate Completion Rates by 6%

Using the number of African American students that started at KCKCC in the 2018-2019 academic year, reducing this achievement gap would yield an additional **84 graduates** annually before adjusting for enrollment increases.

Improve the Female Degree and Certificate Completion Rates by 4%

Using the number of female students that started at KCKCC in the 2018-2019 academic year, reducing this achievement gap would yield an additional **169 graduates** annually before adjusting for enrollment increases.

Improve the Non-Pell Eligible Degree and Certificate Completion Rates by 2%

Using the number of non-Pell eligible students that started at KCKCC in the 2018-2019 academic year, this would yield an additional **27 graduates** annually before adjusting for enrollment increases.

SEM PLAN THEMES AND STRATEGIES

Based on the collective work of the SEM Council, the KCKCC SEM Plan is presented around five key themes.

The SEM Council identified over 100 potential strategies to support the themes. The Council recommends elevating several strategies for broader consideration and resource allocation.

The strategies listed below in bold were identified by the SEM Council as the most critical to initially prioritize.

Enhance and Grow the Enrollment Funnel

- Create a student-facing website for recruitment that is integrated with the Admissions CRM.
- Simplify and streamline the admissions application process.
- Develop a best-in-class campus visit program.
- Expand more alternative course modalities and micro-credentials to meet student and employer demands.
- Increase the conversion of workforce and GED students to academic programs.
- Actively promote and identify signature academic and workforce programs as partners of choice in the Kansas City metropolitan region.

Improve Student Persistence and Completion

- Develop a robust new student orientation and onboarding process.
- Develop a guided pathways advising framework for the entire College.
- Improve and expand student early alert services under a case management approach.
- Enhance developmental education and tutoring services.

Improve the Student Experience

- Establish a one-stop-shop model for enrollment services at all locations.
- Expand student mental health services.
- Expand food services across the College.
- Support more resources to improve trauma-informed practices that bolster student success.

Leverage Financial Assistance to Improve Student Outcomes and Fiscal health

- Develop new scholarship programs that reduce student costs and debt to drive enrollment.
- Establish a student financial wellness engagement and communication plan.
- Establish an athletics scholarship policy.
- Establish a performance/activities-based scholarship policy.
- Streamline the financial aid application process.

Develop and Enhance KCKCC SEM Processes and Policies

- Develop and sustain an annual recruitment plan.
- Develop better entry tracking to identify student intent when entering KCKCC.
- Champion a college-wide data governance framework to support data-driven decision making.
- Improve and expand timely transfer credit processing.
- Leverage withdrawal reason history for planning purposes.

APPENDIX A 2022-23 SEM COUNCIL AND COMMITTEE MEMBERS

The SEM Council members are indicated in bold and served as co-chairs of their respective committees.

- Council Co-Chairs
 - ▶ Dr. Chris Meiers, Vice President for Student Affairs and Enrollment Management
 - ▶ Dr. Donna Bohn; Dean; Arts, Communications, and Humanities
- Data and Forecasting Committee
 - ▶ **Henry Hinkle, Director of Institutional Effectiveness**
 - ▶ **Theresa Holliday, Registrar**
 - ▶ Sam Landau, Enrollment Management Information Systems Coordinator (Staff Senate Rep)
 - ▶ Leslie Strohschein, Controller
 - ▶ Cleon Wiggins, Dean, Social Behavioral Sciences and Public Services
- Recruitment and Marketing Committee
 - ▶ **Kristy Green, Chief Marketing and Institutional Image Officer**
 - ▶ **Teressa Hill, Director of Admissions and Recruitment**
 - ▶ Dr. Cecelia Brewer, Dean, Academic Support and Assessment
 - ▶ Lindsey Bruns, Coordinator, High School Partnerships
 - ▶ Matt Fowler, Web Administrator, Web Services
 - ▶ Ashley Irvin, Interim Dean, Career and Technical Education
 - ▶ Marcia Irvine, Director, Pioneer Career Center

- Completion and Retention Committee
 - ▶ **Brady Beckman, Director of Student Success and Retention**
 - ▶ **Dr. Amanda Williams, Director of Learning Commons**
 - ▶ Danielle Frideres, Career Services Coordinator
 - ▶ Tom Grady, Faculty Director of the Center for Teaching Excellence
 - ▶ Shaun Pate, Instructional Designer, Online Education
 - ▶ Lakshmy Sivaratnam, Professor, Math, Science, Business and Technology
 - ▶ Dr. Stacy Tucker, Service Learning/Phi Theta Kappa Honors Education
 - ▶ Mike Wichtendahl, Instructor, Career and Technical Education
- Scholarships and Financial Aid Committee
 - ▶ **Dr. Shelley Kneuvean, Chief Financial Officer**
 - ▶ **Tammy Reece, Director of Student Financial Aid**
 - ▶ Dorothy (Dottie) Hill, Library Specialists, Learning and Library Services
 - ▶ Katelyn Kolle, Coordinator, Student Financial Aid
 - ▶ Jim Krajewski; Professor; Arts, Communications, and Humanities (Faculty Senate Rep)
 - ▶ Mary Spangler, Executive Director, KCKCC Foundation and Alumni Association
- Student Experience Committee
 - ▶ **Dr. Tiffany Bohm, Dean, Health Professions**
 - ▶ **Andrica Wilcoxon, Director of Student Activities**
 - ▶ Dr. Shawn Derritt, Dean, Student Services
 - ▶ Teri Huggins, Associate Professor, Math Science, Business, and Computer Technology
 - ▶ Colin Immesoete, Administrative Assistant, Learning and Library Services
 - ▶ Kristin Povilonis, Administrative Assistant to the Dean, Career and Technical Education
 - ▶ Kim Taylor, Site Coordinator, Pioneer Career Center
 - ▶ Nicole Wilburn, Director, Student Residence Life

APPENDIX B SUBJECT MATTER EXPERT REVIEWERS

A special thank you goes out to enrollment management experts who provided feedback and critiques of the SEM plan.

Dr. Joey Linn

- Vice President for Student Affairs, Fort Hays State University
- Past-President of the Kansas Association of Collegiate Registrars and Admissions Officers

Mr. John Reed

- Interim Chief Enrollment Office, The Evergreen State College (Washington)
- Former Ruffalo Noel Levitz and Independent Consultant

Mr. Doug Swink

- Assistant Vice President for Enrollment Management, University of Missouri-Kansas City
- Past-President of the Missouri Association of Collegiate Registrars and Admissions Officers

Mr. Ray White

- Retired Director of System Strategic Planning, Washington State University
- Certified Society for College and University Planners Consultant

APPENDIX C REFERENCES

i Education Design Lab. (2023, March 20). How micro-pathways are transforming Pima Community College - Education Design Lab. <https://eddesignlab.org/news-events/how-micro-pathways-are-transforming-pima-community-college/>

ii Mowreader, A. (2023). Consolidating touch points for retention. Inside Higher Ed | Higher Education News, Events and Jobs. <https://www.insidehighered.com/news/2023/02/27/consolidating-touch-points-retention>

iii Conroy, E. (2023, January 22). Given Delays, Higher Education Observers Are Worried About New FAFSA. Forbes. <https://www.forbes.com/sites/edwardconroy/2023/01/22/given-delays-higher-education-observers-are-worried-about-new-fafsa/?sh=6fb58cad58c2>

